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Dual drainage bag, assemblies, and related methods

Abstract

Devices used to collect bodily fluids are disclosed. The devices may include a fluid bag and a transformable hanger for mounting the fluid bag to a support structure such as a hospital bed rail. The fluid bag can include a first fluid compartment and a second fluid compartment. The devices may further include a displaceable front cover and a back cover to obscure the bodily fluids from observation.

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Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/836,585, filed Mar. 31, 2020, and titled DUAL DRAINAGE BAG, ASSEMBLIES, AND RELATED METHODS, which claims priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 62/827,724, filed Apr. 1, 2019, and titled DUAL DRAINAGE BAG, ASSEMBLIES, AND RELATED METHODS, and U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 62/938,452, filed Nov. 21,

2019, and titled DUAL DRAINAGE BAG, ASSEMBLIES, AND RELATED METHODS, each of which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates generally to the field of medical devices. More specifically, the present disclosure relates to bodily fluid drainage assemblies and related methods of use.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The embodiments disclosed herein will become more fully apparent from the following description and appended claims, taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings. These drawings depict only typical embodiments, which will be described with additional specificity and detail through use of the accompanying drawings in which:
- (2) FIG. 1 is a plan view of a bodily fluid drainage assembly, depicted in an unassembled configuration.
- (3) FIG. 2 is a partial view of the bodily fluid drainage assembly of FIG. 1, depicted as it is being assembled.
- (4) FIG. 3 is a partial view of the bodily fluid drainage assembly of FIG. 1, depicted in an assembled configuration.
- (5) FIG. 4 is a partial view of the bodily fluid drainage assembly of FIG. 3, depicted with a hanger in a folded state.
- (6) FIG. 5A is a front view of the bodily fluid drainage assembly of FIG. 3, depicted with the hanger in an unfolded state.
- (7) FIG. 5B is a front view of the bodily fluid drainage assembly of FIG. 3, depicted with the hanger in partially folded state.
- (8) FIG. 5C is a front view of the bodily fluid drainage assembly of FIG. 3, depicted with the hanger in a folded state.
- (9) FIG. 6A is a front view of a bodily fluid drainage assembly, depicted with a cover.
- (10) FIG. 6B is a front view of the bodily fluid drainage assembly of FIG. 6A, depicted with the cover partially lifted.
- (11) FIG. 7 is an end view of the bodily fluid drainage assembly of FIG. 6A.
- (12) FIG. 8 is a front view of a bodily fluid drainage assembly mounted to a hospital bed rail.
- (13) FIG. 9 is a front view of a bodily fluid drainage assembly mounted to a hospital bed rail opposite of the hospital bed rail of FIG. 8.
- (14) FIG. 10 is a front view of a bodily fluid drainage assembly mounted to a rail or support structure.
- (15) FIG. 11A is a partial view of a bodily fluid drainage assembly, depicted with a hanger in an unfolded state.
- (16) FIG. 11B is a partial view of the bodily fluid drainage assembly of FIG. 11A, depicted with the hanger in a folded state.
- (17) FIG. 12A is a partial view of a bodily fluid drainage assembly, depicted with a hanger in an unfolded state.
- (18) FIG. 12B is a partial view of the bodily fluid drainage assembly of FIG. 11A, depicted with the hanger in a folded state.
- (19) FIG. 13 is plan view of a bodily fluid drainage assembly, depicted in an unassembled configuration.
- (20) FIG. 14 is a perspective view of a forming structure that can be used with a bodily fluid drainage assembly.
- (21) FIG. 15 is a plan view of a bodily fluid drainage assembly, depicted in an unassembled

configuration.

(22) FIG. 16A is a partial view of a bodily fluid drainage assembly, depicted with a hanger in an unfolded state.

(23) FIG. 16B is a partial view of the bodily fluid drainage assembly of FIG. 16A, depicted with the hanger in a folded state.

(24) FIG. 17 is an end view of a bodily fluid drainage assembly.

(25) FIG. 18A is a front view of a bodily fluid drainage assembly, depicted with the outlet tube in a folded configuration.

(26) FIG. 18B is a front view of the bodily fluid drainage assembly of FIG. 18A, depicted with the outlet tube in an extended configuration.

(27) FIG. 19 is a front view of another bodily fluid drainage assembly, depicted with the outlet tube in an extended configuration.

(28) FIG. 20A is a partial view of a bodily fluid drainage assembly, depicted with a hanger in an unfolded state.

(29) FIG. 20B is a partial view of the bodily fluid drainage assembly of FIG. 20A, depicted with the hanger in a folded state.

(30) FIG. 21 is an exploded perspective view of the hanger and a base of the bodily fluid drainage assembly of FIG. 20A.

(31) FIG. 22A is a top perspective view of the hanger and base of the bodily fluid drainage assembly of FIG. 20A, depicted in a pre-locked configuration.

(32) FIG. 22B is a bottom perspective view of the hanger and base of the bodily fluid drainage assembly of FIG. 20A, depicted in the pre-locked configuration.

(33) FIG. 23A is a top perspective view of the hanger and base of the bodily fluid drainage assembly of FIG. 20A, depicted in a locked configuration.

(34) FIG. 23B is a bottom perspective view of the hanger and base of the bodily fluid drainage assembly of FIG. 20A, depicted in the locked configuration.

(35) FIG. 24A is a front view of a cover of a bodily fluid drainage assembly.

(36) FIG. 24B is a front view of another bodily fluid drainage assembly including the cover of FIG. 24A in an obscuring orientation.

(37) FIG. 25 is a perspective view of another embodiment of a bodily fluid drainage assembly including a rotatable elbow connector.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(38) A fluid drainage assembly may include a fluid bag configured to receive bodily fluid drained from a site within a human body, such as a bladder. The fluid bag may include various components, such as an inlet port configured to couple to a drainage tube, an outlet tube having an output regulator, one or more fluid compartments, one or more air vents (which can allow passage of gas or air into and/or out of the fluid compartments), and/or a volume indicator. In some instances, each fluid compartment may include transparent or translucent front and/or back panels. Each fluid compartment may also include a displaceable cover to obscure observation of the bodily fluid collected within the fluid compartment or fluid bag. In certain instances, the drainage assembly may include a transformable hanger coupled to the fluid bag and configured to suspend the fluid bag from a support structure, such as a bed rail. The hanger may be configured to transform configurations such that either the first fluid compartment or the second fluid compartment faces outward toward a clinician. In doing so, the fluid drainage assembly can be disposed at various locations on a support structure (e.g., bed or chair structure), and on either side of the support structure (e.g., bed or chair structure).

(39) Embodiments may be understood by reference to the drawings, wherein like parts are designated by like numerals throughout. It will be readily understood by one of ordinary skill in the art having the benefit of this disclosure that the components of the embodiments, as generally described and illustrated in the figures herein, could be arranged and designed in a wide variety of

different configurations. Thus, the following more detailed description of various embodiments, as represented in the figures, is not intended to limit the scope of the disclosure but is merely representative of various embodiments. While the various aspects of the embodiments are presented in drawings, the drawings are not necessarily drawn to scale unless specifically indicated. (40) It will be appreciated that various features are sometimes grouped together in a single embodiment, figure, or description thereof for the purpose of streamlining the disclosure. Many of these features may be used alone and/or in combination with one another.

(41) The phrase “coupled to” refers to any form of interaction between two or more entities, including mechanical, electrical, magnetic, electromagnetic, fluid, and thermal interaction. Two components may be coupled to each other even though they are not in direct contact with each other. For example, two components may be coupled to each other through an intermediate component.

(42) “Fluid” is used in its broadest sense, to refer to any fluid, including both liquids and gases as well as solutions, compounds, suspensions, etc., which generally behave as fluids.

(43) FIG. 1 depicts a bodily fluid drainage assembly **100** in an unassembled configuration or state. The bodily fluid drainage assembly **100** includes a drainage bag assembly **110** and a hanger **150**. The drainage bag assembly **110** includes one or more fluid compartments **121**, **122**. The fluid compartments **121**, **122** can also be referred to as fluid bags or fluid receptacles. As detailed below, the drainage assembly **100** is configured to receive bodily drainage fluid; retain the drainage fluid; and/or selectively drain the drainage fluid from the drainage assembly **100**. In some embodiments, the drainage assembly **100** is also configured to at least partially obscure the visibility of the drainage fluid while allowing an approximate volume of the fluid to be determined; and/or optionally allow the fluid to be directly viewed by at least partially displacing or removing a portion of the drainage assembly **100**.

(44) In the embodiment of FIG. 1, the drainage bag assembly **110** includes a first fluid compartment **121** and a second fluid compartment **122**. The fluid compartments **121**, **122** are in fluid communication with one another, such that fluid from one compartment **121**, **122** can flow to and from the other compartment **121**, **122**. The flow can be unobstructed and free of interference. For instance, fluid from the first fluid compartment **121** can flow to the second compartment **122** and vice versa. At least one of the fluid compartments **121**, **122** comprises an inlet port **116**. At least one of the fluid compartments **121**, **122** can comprise an air vent **117**. Further, in some embodiments, each of the fluid compartments **121**, **122** comprises an air vent **117**. The air vent **117** can allow for air and/or gas to flow into and/or out of the fluid compartments **121**, **122**. For example, air and/or gas can be released from the fluid compartment **121**, **122** as it fills with bodily fluid. Air and/or gas can also flow into the fluid compartment **121**, **122** as the bodily fluid is drained from the fluid compartment **121**, **122**.

(45) As shown in FIG. 1, the fluid compartments **121**, **122** may comprise a front or first panel **123** and a back or second panel **124**, which may be made of one or more liquid impervious materials. For example, the front and back panels **123**, **124** may be formed from polyvinyl chloride, polyurethane, vinyl, polymeric, or any other suitable material. At least a portion of the front and back panels **123**, **124** can be substantially transparent or translucent such that a drainage fluid contained within the fluid compartments **121**, **122** may be readily observed. The panels **123**, **124** may be coupled or joined along a other suitable technique. When coupled together, the panels **123**, **124** form a fillable void that may receive drainage fluid via a drainage tube **112** and a corresponding inlet port **116** that are located on an upper portion of at least one of the fluid compartments **121**, **122**. The panels **123**, **124** can also be flexible rather than rigid, such that the fluid compartments **121**, **122** can expand as they fill with drainage fluid.

(46) It will further be appreciated that a variety of types and configurations of fluid bags can be utilized without departing from the scope and spirit of the present disclosure. For example, the fluid compartments **121**, **122** may be manufactured using a one-piece method, wherein the fluid

compartments **121**, **122** comprise a single piece of plastic that is folded along one or more edges and, further, is sealed to itself or otherwise closed along one or more edges. A two-piece manufacturing method can also be used, wherein two separate panels are coupled together. Further, the shape and size of drainage assembly **100** is primarily for illustrative purposes and may vary. In the depicted embodiment, the drainage bag assembly **110** is configured in a horizontal or landscape configuration where the height of the bag is less the width of the bag. This configuration allows for the drainage bag assembly **110** to be hung from a support, such as a hospital bed rail, that may be located as low as approximately seven inches from a floor surface—as illustrated in FIGS. **8-9** where D.sub.1 may be lowered to less than 18 inches, less than 12 inches, less than 10 inches, or less than 8 inches (e.g., when the bed is in the lowered state).

(47) As further shown in FIG. **1**, the first and second fluid compartments **121**, **122** can be defined by one or more seams **125**, **126** that extend across a central region of the drainage bag assembly **110**. For instance, the illustrated embodiment includes a first seam **125** and a second seam **126** that are disposed between the first and second fluid compartments **121**, **122**. The seams can be made in various ways, such as via radio frequency (RF) welding, heat sealing, gluing, or any other suitable technique. The seams **125**, **126** can also be discontinuous, such that they do not block the flow of fluid between the fluid compartments **121**, **122**. For example, the seams **125**, **126** can be referred to as spot seams (or spot welds).

(48) The seams **125**, **126** can couple one or more portions of the panels **123**, **124** together. The seams **125**, **126** can also define fold regions along which the drainage bag assembly **110** folds when assembled. In other embodiments, the first and second fluid compartments **121**, **122** are defined by fold lines, as the drainage bag assembly **110** can be folded to form two halves or fluid compartments **121**, **122** (which can double the volume of fluid for a given bag height).

(49) In certain embodiments, the drainage bag assembly **110** further includes one or more conduits **130** that can be configured to communicate with each of the fluid compartments **121**, **122**. In such embodiments, fluid can flow through the conduits **130** and between the fluid compartments **121**, **122**. The conduits **130** can be disposed within the drainage bag assembly **110**, and can be held in place via one or more seams **128**, which can be formed in various ways, such as via radio frequency (RF) welding, heat sealing, gluing, or any other suitable technique. The conduits **130** can also be held in place by an adhesive, such as a glue. In other embodiments, conduits **130** are not used.

(50) As illustrated, an outlet tube **113** can also be disposed between the fluid compartments **121**, **122**. The outlet tube **113** may allow the drainage fluid contained within the fluid compartments **121**, **122** to be selectively drained from or retained within the fluid compartments **121**, **122** via an output regulator **114**. The output regulator **114** may comprise a plastic or metal clip, in-line valve, rotatable valve, or any other suitable structure. At least one of the fluid compartments **121**, **122** may further comprise an outlet tube holder **115** that comprises a slot, loop, pocket, or hook that is configured to receive and reversibly retain outlet tube **113** in an at least partially upright or folded position. For example, in the illustrated embodiment, the outlet tube holder **115** comprises a plastic tube so as to define a cavity. When the drainage assembly **100** is in use or a pre-use state, a bottom end of the outlet tube **113** can be positioned within the cavity of the outlet tube holder **115**. The outlet tube **113** can be removed from the outlet tube holder **115** and allowed to hang downwardly into the extended position shown in FIG. **7** during drainage of fluid from the fluid compartments **121**, **122**.

(51) The drainage bag assembly **110** can be folded and/or assembled prior to use. For example, as shown in FIGS. **2-4**, the drainage bag assembly **110** can be folded such that the first fluid compartment **121** and the second fluid compartment **122** are parallel to one another, or side by side. In some embodiments, the drainage bag assembly **110** is folded along seams **125**, **126** or predetermined fold lines. The first fluid compartment **121** can also be coupled to the second fluid compartment **122** such that the drainage bag assembly **110** can remain in the folded or assembled

configuration.

(52) For instance, as shown in FIG. 2, the drainage bag assembly **110** includes a base or brace **140** that extends between the first and second fluid compartments **121**, **122**. The brace **140** can be coupled to an elongate member **151** of each of the first and second fluid compartments **121**, **122**. For instance, with reference to FIGS. 2-4, each of the first and second fluid compartments **121**, **122** includes an elongate member **151**. In some embodiments, the elongate member **151** may be configured as a non-linear, elongate bar. In other embodiments, the elongate member **151** may be configured as a linear, elongate bar. In some instances, the elongate member **151** can also include horizontal and angled segments that permit the elongate member **151** to avoid interference with features of the drainage bag assembly **110**, such as the inlet port **116** and the air vent **117** when used with or coupled to the fluid compartments **121**, **122**. For example, a portion **159** of the elongate member **151** may extend toward the inlet port **116** and may include two horizontal segments and two angled segments. As another example, another portion **160** of the elongate member **151** may extend toward the air vent **117** and may include two horizontal segments and an angled segment disposed between the horizontal segments. The elongate member **151** may also include at least one retention feature **162**. The retention feature **162** may be configured to retain the wings **154**, **155** of the hanger **150** in a folded or deployed state as illustrated in FIG. 4. The retention feature **162** may be in the form of a bump, ridge, nub, boss, etc. or any other suitable form.

(53) In FIG. 2, the brace **140** is shown coupled to the first elongate member **151a** and uncoupled from the second elongate member **151b**. The brace **140** can be coupled to each of the elongate members **151a**, **151b** in an analogous manner, or in a different manner, as desired. For instance, the brace **140** can include one or more coupling members **142** that can couple to each of the elongate members **151**. Thus, while only one side of the brace **140** is depicted in the illustrated embodiment, it will be appreciated that the opposite side of the brace **140** can be configured in a similar manner if desired.

(54) The coupling members **142** can be configured to couple to the elongate member **151** in various ways. For instance, in the illustrated embodiment, the elongate member **151** includes complementary coupling members **143** that are configured to mate with or otherwise couple with the coupling members **142** of the brace **140**. In some instances, the coupling of the brace **140** to the elongate member **151** is non-reversible, such that the elongate members **151** (and/or fluid compartments **121**, **122**) are not intended to be unassembled or uncoupled from the brace **140** after being coupled thereto. With reference to FIG. 2, for instance, the brace **140** includes first coupling members **142** that are configured to be inserted into and/or received by second coupling members **143** of the second elongate member **151b**. Once inserted, the coupling members **142**, **143** can be formed such that they are not intended to be uncoupled (e.g., such as in a snap fit engagement). Various types of coupling members **142**, **143** can be used, including mating coupling members, latches, buttons, snap-fit engagements, and the like. In other embodiments, the brace **140** can be reversibly coupled to the one or more elongate members **151**.

(55) FIGS. 3 and 4 depict the drainage bag assembly **110** in an assembled configuration. As shown in FIG. 3, the coupling members **142** of the brace **140** have been inserted into the coupling members of the elongate member **151**. The drainage bag assembly **110** further includes a hanger or rail clip **150**. The hanger or rail clip **150** can be coupled to or disposed on the brace **140**. For example, in the illustrated embodiment of FIGS. 3 and 4, the hanger **150** can be positioned and extend from the brace **140**.

(56) The hanger **150** can be configured to allow the drainage assembly **100** to be suspended from a patient, or from a support structure, such as a wheelchair, bed, a bed rail, or stand. As shown in FIG. 4, the hanger can be positioned such that it is directed towards either side of the drainage bag assembly **110**. For instance, the hanger **150b** can be positioned towards the first fluid compartment **121**, or the hanger **150a** can be positioned towards the second fluid compartment **122**, as desired by the practitioner (e.g., a practitioner may suspend the drainage assembly **100** in either direction,

depending on a desired orientation of the inlet port **116** and tube **112**.)

(57) As illustrated in FIGS. 5A-5C, the hanger **150** may include a central portion **153**, a first laterally extending member or wing **154**, and a second laterally extending portion or wing **155**. The hanger **150** may be formed as an integral unit using any suitable manufacturing technique, such as injection molding, casting, machining, etc. In other embodiments, the hanger **150** may be assembled from separate components using any suitable assembly technique. The hanger **150** may be formed from any suitable material, such as a polymeric material like polypropylene, polyethylene, blends thereof, etc.

(58) The central portion **153** may be coupled to the brace **140** and may also include a flexible or living hinge **158** such that a face of the central portion **153** is oriented parallel to a vertical axis or plane of the elongate members **151** in an undeployed state, as illustrated in FIG. 5A. The living hinge **158** may allow the central portion to pivot or fold about the living hinge **158** approximately or at least 180 degrees relative to the vertical axis or plane of the elongate member **151** (e.g., at least 90 degrees in either direction). In other words, the central portion **153** may be pivoted from a vertical orientation to a horizontal orientation on either side of the elongate member **151** when the hanger **150** is deployed, as depicted in FIGS. 5B-5C.

(59) The first and second wings **154**, **155** may be coupled to the central portion **153** via a flexible or living hinge **156** such that the wings **154**, **155** are oriented in a plane of the face of the central portion **153** in the undeployed state, as shown in FIGS. 5B-5C. The living hinge **156** may allow the wings **154**, **155** to pivot or fold about the living hinge **156** approximately or at least 180 degrees relative to the plane of the face of the central portion **153** (e.g., at least 90 degrees in either direction). In other words, the wings **154**, **155** may be pivoted from the parallel orientation to a perpendicular orientation on either side of the central portion **153** when the hanger **150** is deployed, as depicted in FIG. 4. The wings **154**, **155** may include a support receiver **152** configured to be clipped over or disposed over a portion of a hospital bed rail. In other embodiments, the support receiver **152** may be configured to be clipped over or disposed over any suitable support, such as a wheelchair, a stand, etc. In certain embodiments, adjacent edges of the elongate member **151**, central portion **153** and wings **154**, **155** may be radiused or double beveled to facilitate pivoting or folding.

(60) As shown in the depicted embodiment, the wings **154**, **155** may also include an elongate member receiver or elongate member section receiver **161**. The elongate member receiver **161** may have a substantially U-shaped form where a portion of the elongate member **151** can be removably disposed within the elongate member receiver **161** when the hanger **150** is deployed. In some instances, the retention feature(s) **162** can also aid in retaining the wings **154**, **155** in a folded or deployed state. For example, the wings **154**, **155** can be forced over the retention feature(s) **162** as the hanger **150** is folded or deployed. The retention feature(s) **162** can then retain the wings **154**, **155** in the folded or deployed state absent application of an outside force to unfold the wings **154**, **155**.

(61) In certain embodiments, the wings **154**, **155** may further include brace extension receiver **162**. The brace extension receiver **162** may also have a substantially U-shaped form where a portion of the brace extension **144** can be removably disposed within the brace extension receiver **162** when the hanger **150** is deployed. The brace extensions **144** can protrude from the brace **140** and can be configured to further aid in retaining and/or supporting the hanger when in a deployed or folded state. The brace extension **144** can also include retention features if desired.

(62) As previously discussed, in the illustrated embodiment, the hanger or rail clip **150** is configured to be oriented either toward the first fluid compartment **121** or the second fluid compartment **122** when deployed. This dual orientation capability of the hanger **150** permits the drainage assembly **100** to be suspended from a support, such as a bed rail, with either the first fluid compartment **121** or the second fluid compartment **122** directed outwardly toward a viewer. Additionally, the dual orientation capability allows the viewer to orient the drainage assembly **100**

at various locations along a support structure (e.g., upwards (towards the head) or downwards (towards the feet) from the bladder of a patient) or on either side of the support structure (e.g., bed structure) and still have the drainage port **116** adjacent a patient's drainage site in order to route the drainage tube **112** easily to the drainage site.

(63) In some embodiments, an approximate volume of drainage fluid within the fluid bag **111** may be ascertained via a bag volume indicator **132**, which may comprise marks or graduations **134**, **135** on at least one panel **124** of each of the fluid compartments **121**, **122**. In the depicted embodiment, graduations **134**, **135** denote various predetermined volumes and may be printed on each of the fluid compartments **121**, **122**. In another embodiment, the graduations **134**, **135** may comprise raised or recessed portions of the fluid compartments **121**, **122** that are formed during or after manufacturing of the each of the fluid compartments **121**, **122**. The graduations **134**, **135** may represent any predetermined measurement of volume, such as fluid ounces and/or milliliters, and may vary in their relative distributions accordingly. In some embodiments, the space between sequential graduations **134**, **135** may not be uniform in scale so as to account for a non-linear rate of rise in fluid level, such as may result from expansion of the fluid compartment **121**, **122** as the fluid compartment **121**, **122** fills with drainage fluid and/or from a transverse dimension of the fluid compartment **121**, **122** that varies with a height of the bag. In the depicted embodiment, the graduations **134**, **135** are located on a right portion (as seen from the viewer's perspective) of the fluid compartment **121**, **122**; however, in other embodiments, the graduations may be located at any suitable location on the fluid compartment **121**, **122**. In the illustrated embodiment, the volume indicator **132** also extends upwardly. Since at least a portion of the fluid compartment **121**, **122** is transparent or semitransparent (e.g., translucent), the top of the drainage fluid can be compared to the graduations **134**, **135** to thereby determine the volume of the fluid, or the approximate volume thereof.

(64) As shown in FIGS. **6A** and **6B**, in certain embodiments, one or more (or both) of the fluid compartments **221** further comprises a cover **281** that can be formed from or otherwise include an opaque material (or at least partially opaque material capable of obscuring the appearance of a fluid positioned at one side thereof), and that may define a similar shape as the fluid compartment **221**. For example, the cover **281** may be formed from polyvinyl chloride, polyurethane, vinyl, polymeric, or any other suitable material. As depicted, the cover **281** is located adjacent to and is configured to obscure the fluid compartment **221**. A second cover (not depicted) can also be disposed on an opposite side of the bag and in front of the second fluid compartment. The covers **281** have an outer edge that may be at least partially aligned with an outer edge of the fluid compartments **221**. However, at least a portion of the outer edge of the covers **281** may extend outwardly beyond the outer edge of the fluid compartment **221**, if desired.

(65) The cover **281** can be coupled or attached to the fluid compartment **221** in any suitable manner, such as RF welding, heat sealing, gluing, hardware, etc. In the illustrated embodiment, the cover **281** is fixedly attached to the fluid compartment **221** along a seam which extends along an upper edge of the cover **281**. The seam may provide an area or region of weakness along which the cover **281** may be readily removed from the fluid compartment **221**, if desired. Other regions of weakness (e.g., perforations) may also be used.

(66) The cover **281** may be said to be integral with the fluid compartment **221**. For example, in some embodiments, the drainage assembly **200** is sterilized and packaged with all of the components shown in FIG. **6A**. While it may be possible to remove the cover **281** from the drainage assembly **200**, as just discussed, the cover **281** is nevertheless a fixed and permanent component of the drainage assembly **200**. For example, if the cover **281** is removed by peeling it along its region of weakness, a portion of the cover **281** (generally the portion that is attached to the panels **221** by the seam) can nevertheless remain attached to the fluid compartment **221**. In other embodiments, the cover **181** can be selectively attachable to and detachable from the drainage assembly **200**, such as with snaps, hook-and-loop fasteners, adhesives, or any other suitable

temporary fastening system. For example, the fasteners can be positioned along an upper edge of the cover **281**.

(67) As previously mentioned, the cover **281** is coupled or attached to the drainage assembly **200** at an upper end of the fluid compartment **221**. The cover **281** thus naturally hangs or drapes downward so as to be positioned in front of the face of the panel **224** and/or fluid compartment **221**. The cover **281** can thus conceal or obscure viewing of a large portion of the panel **224** and/or fluid compartment **221**, when the drainage assembly **200** is viewed from a position in front of or behind the drainage assembly **200**. A lower edge of the cover **281** may not be attached to the fluid compartment **221** such that at least a portion of the cover **281** may be lifted to expose the fluid compartment **221** and its contents. In other embodiments, the lower edge of the cover **281** may be selectively attached to the fluid compartment **221**. Such selective attachment and detachment may be achieved in any suitable manner, such as via snaps, hook-and-loop fasteners, adhesives, or other suitable releasable fastening system. In other embodiments, a cover can be configured as a slip cover that is disposed over the fluid bag assembly. For instance, a polymeric or fabric cover can be disposed over the fluid bag assembly rather than coupled thereto.

(68) The cover **281** can include one or more volume indicators **285**. The illustrated first volume indicator **285** includes a window **282** and one or more graduations **283**. A variety of configurations for the window **282** and the graduations **283** are possible. For example, a variety of shapes are possible for the window **282**, and the number and arrangement of the graduations **283** may be varied. In the illustrated embodiment, the window **282** defines a permanent opening through the cover **281** and is fully encompassed by solid or unbroken portions of the cover **281**. The window **282** defines a small, vertically oriented longitudinal slot. Only a small portion of the fluid compartment **221** is visible through the window **282** when the cover **281** are in the obscuring orientation. An approximate volume level can be determined when a top level of the drainage fluid is visible through the window **282**, such as by comparing the level of the drainage fluid to the graduations **283**. Due to the fixed relationship between the upper end of the cover **281** and the fluid compartment **221**, the graduations **283** can provide a substantially accurate assessment of the approximate liquid volume when the cover **281** hangs downwardly.

(69) In the illustrated embodiment, the window **282** may be oriented such that a portion of the graduations **234**, **235** that are on the fluid compartment **221** are visible through the window **282** when the cover **281** are in the obscuring orientation. In certain embodiments, the bag graduations **234**, **235** may be offset relative to the cover graduations **283** when the fluid compartment **221** is devoid of fluid. The offset can account for relative movement between the cover **281** and the fluid compartment **221** as the fluid compartment **221** fills with fluid. In particular, the fluid compartment **221** can transition from a generally flat configuration to an outwardly expanded or bowed configuration as it fills with the drainage fluid, and in some arrangements, the cover **281** may not strictly match the contour of the fluid compartment **281** as it expands. This relative shift in positions can cause the graduations **283** of the first volume indicator **285** to come into greater alignment with the graduations **234**, **235** of the bag volume indicator **232**.

(70) The cover **281** may include a second volume indicator **286**. The second volume indicator **286** includes a recess, such as a notch or cutout **287**, and a set of graduations **288**. A bottom end of the cutout **287** is at a position that is horizontally offset and/or spaced vertically from an upper end of the window **282**. Due to the difference in vertical positions between the cutout **287** and the window **282**, a top level of the drainage fluid can remain below the cutout **287** at all times that the window **282** is used in determining the approximate volume of the drainage fluid, and the top level of the drainage fluid can remain above the window **282** at all times that the cutout **287** is used in determining the approximate volume of the drainage fluid.

(71) Each of the window **282** and the cutout **287** may be referred to as an aperture or opening in the cover **281** through which a portion of the panel **224** of the fluid compartment **221** may be directly viewed. The window **282** and the cutout **287** may be formed in any suitable manner, such as, for

example, by stamping, cutting, or punching.

(72) By way of further explanation, in the illustrated embodiment, the cover **281** is formed of a flexible material. When the drainage assembly **200** is in the unfilled state, the fluid compartment **221** can be substantially planar or flat, and the cover **281** can hang substantially vertically and may likewise be substantially planar or flat. The cover **281** may be positioned exclusively forward of the panel **224**, and it may obscure an entirety of the panel **224** or fluid compartment **221** (except for those portions that are visible through the window **282** and the cutout **287**) from all or nearly all vantage points that are forward of the drainage assembly **200**. A second cover (not depicted) may be positioned exclusively behind the second fluid compartment, and it may obscure an entirety of the second fluid compartment (except for those portions that are visible through a window and a cutout) from all or nearly all vantage points that are rearward or backward of the drainage assembly **200**.

(73) In FIG. **6A**, the cover **281** is shown in an obscuring (e.g., draped or lowered) orientation. In other words, the cover **281** is shown obscuring at least a portion of the panel **224** and/or fluid compartment **221**. In FIG. **6B**, the cover **281** is shown in a viewing (e.g., raised) orientation. In other words, the lower edge of the cover **281** is shown lifted to reveal at least a portion of the panel **224** and/or fluid compartment **221**. A second cover can be configured to function in a similar manner relative to the second fluid compartment. It is noted that the term “obscuring orientation,” when used with respect to the cover **281**, does not necessarily connote that an entirety of the panel **224** and/or fluid compartment **221** is obscured (e.g., blocked or guarded from view, rendered difficult to view, or provided with a significantly altered appearance) by the cover **281**. Indeed, as demonstrated by the embodiment depicted in FIG. **6A**, restricted portions of the panel **224** and/or fluid compartment **221** can be viewed, observed, or visualized through the window **282** and the cutout **287** when the cover **281** is in the obscuring orientation.

(74) FIG. **7** depicts an end view of a drainage assembly **200** that includes first and second fluid compartments **221**, **222** each having a cover **281**, **284** coupled thereto. As shown in FIG. **7**, the covers **281**, **284** drape over the outwardly facing surfaces of the first and second fluid compartments **221**, **222**. In such a manner, fluid **205** within the fluid compartments **221**, **222** can be obscured from view by an observer. A bottom portion of the covers **281**, **284** can also be lifted as desired to view the fluid **205** within the fluid compartments **221**, **222**.

(75) The drainage assembly **200** further includes a hanger **250** that is configured to couple to a rail **202** or other structure. In the illustrated embodiment, the hanger **250** is depicted in a folded configuration or state, wherein the support receiver **262** is disposed over a rail **202**. Additionally, the elongate member receiver **261** is depicted as being disposed over an elongate member **251** of the first fluid compartment **221**, and the brace extension receiver **162** is depicted as being disposed over a brace extension **244** of the brace **240**.

(76) Additionally, FIG. **7** depicts a conduit **230** in communication with the first and second fluid compartments **221**, **222**. Fluid **205** can flow through a lumen **232** in the conduit **230** such that the fluid level in each of the fluid compartments is substantially the same. The conduit **230** also includes a notch or opening **231** such that fluid can flow out of the conduit **230** and towards the drainage tube **213**. One or more conduits **230** can be used. Other structures can also be used to ensure flow is not substantially restricted (and can flow freely) between the fluid compartments **221**, **222**.

(77) FIGS. **8-9** depict the drainage assembly **200** in use with a patient **203**. As shown therein, the drainage assembly **200** may be suspended from a bed rail **202** that is coupled to a hospital bed **201**. As discussed previously, the bed rail **202** may be positioned adjacent the floor such that a distance from the bed rail **202** to the floor is distance D.sub.1. In some embodiments, as depicted in FIG. **8**, the hospital bed **201** is configured to be lowered to be adjacent the floor (which can minimize a fall distance if a patient **203** falls out of the hospital bed **201**). For instance, D.sub.1 may be lowered to less than 18 inches, less than 12 inches, less than 10 inches, or less than 8 inches (e.g., when the

bed **201** is in the lowered state). Stated another way, the bed **201** may be lowered such that D.sub.1 is between about 6 and about 18 inches, between about 6 and about 12 inches, between about 6 and about 10 inches, or between about 6 and about 8 inches. In such embodiments, the drainage assembly **200** can be suspended from the bed rail **202** such that it does not touch the floor, even while the hospital bed **201** is in the lowered state. The hanger **250** can be folded to permit the hospital bed **201** to be lowered closer to the floor because of the low-profile configuration of the deployed hanger **250**.

(78) The drainage assembly **200** may also be oriented on either side of the bed structure **201** (or at various locations along the bed rail **202** (e.g., more towards the head or more towards the feet of the patient **203**), such that either the first fluid compartment **221** and the first cover **281** are directed outwardly as shown in FIG. **8** (which depicts a first side of the hospital bed **201** or bed rail **102**) or such that the second fluid compartment **222** and the second cover **284** are directed outwardly as shown in FIG. **9** (which depicts a second or opposite side of the hospital bed **201** or bed rail **202**). For example, the hanger or rail clip **250** may be deployed such that the hanger **250** is oriented toward the second fluid compartment **222** when the first fluid compartment **221** is directed outwardly. In such instances, the central portion **253** may be pivoted or folded towards the second fluid compartment **222** and the wings **254**, **255** may be pivoted or folded downwardly toward the base region **251** of the hanger **250** such that a portion of the elongate member **251** is received within the elongate member receiver **261** (e.g., shown in phantom in FIG. **10**). If the user desires that the second fluid compartment **222** and the second cover **284** be directed outwardly, the hanger **250** may be deployed such that the hanger **250** is oriented toward the first fluid compartment **221**. The central portion **253** may be pivoted or folded towards the first fluid compartment **221** and the wings **254**, **255** may be pivoted or folded downwardly toward the elongate member **251** of the hanger **250** such that a portion of the base region **251** is received within the elongate member receiver **252** (e.g., shown in FIG. **10**).

(79) The drainage tube **212** may also be coupled to the patient's drainage site such that drainage fluid can fill the fluid compartments **221**, **222**. The first cover **281** and/or the second cover **284** may obscure the drainage fluid within the fluid compartments **221**, **222**. A viewer may observe the volume of drainage fluid within the fluid compartments **221**, **222** by viewing the drainage fluid through the first volume indicator **285** and/or the second volume indicator **286**. Alternatively, the healthcare worker may observe the volume of drainage fluid within a fluid compartment **221**, **222** by lifting a lower portion of the outwardly directed cover **281**, **284** and observing the drainage fluid volume through the outwardly directed fluid compartment **221**, **222**.

(80) Various other types of hangers can also be used in accordance with the fluid assemblies, as shown in FIGS. **11A-11B** and **12A-12B**. For instance, the hanger **350** of FIGS. **11A-11B** does not include a brace receiver or slot. Rather, the hanger is only coupled to the elongate member **351**. And in FIGS. **12A-12B**, the hanger **450** does not couple to the brace or the elongate member. Other types of hangers can also be used.

(81) FIG. **13** depicts a bodily fluid drainage assembly **500** in accordance with another embodiment. As shown in FIG. **13**, the bodily fluid drainage assembly **500** includes a forming structure **529** that can aid in allowing fluid to flow between the first and second fluid compartments **521**, **522**. The forming structure **529** can be disposed within the bag structure. For instance, the forming structure **529** can be disposed between the first and second fluid compartments **521**, **522** and can be held in place via one or more seams **525**, **526**. The forming structure **529** can provide a form or shape to a bottom portion of the bag structure (e.g., after it is folded and/or assembled to form first and second fluid compartments **521**, **522**). The height and/or size of the forming structure can vary as desired. A perspective view of an exemplary forming structure **529** is shown in FIG. **14**. Other types and/or shapes and sizes of forming structures can also be used.

(82) FIG. **15** depicts another embodiment of a bodily fluid drainage assembly **600** in an unassembled configuration or state. The bodily fluid drainage assembly **600** includes a drainage

bag assembly **610** and a hanger **650**. In the embodiment of FIG. **15**, the drainage bag assembly **610** includes a first fluid compartment **621** and a second fluid compartment **622**. The fluid compartments **621**, **622** are in fluid communication with one another, such that fluid from one compartment **621**, **622** can flow to and from the other compartment **621**, **622**. At least one of the fluid compartments **621**, **622** comprises an inlet port **616**. If desired, at least one of the fluid compartments **621**, **622** can comprise an air vent (such as the air vent **117** depicted in FIG. **1**).

(83) As shown in FIG. **15**, the fluid compartments **621**, **622** may comprise a front or first panel **623** and a back or second panel **624**, which may be made of one or more liquid impervious materials. For example, the front and back panels **623**, **624** may be formed from polyvinyl chloride, polyurethane, vinyl, polymeric, or any other suitable material. At least a portion of the front and back panels **623**, **624** can be substantially transparent or translucent such that a drainage fluid contained within the fluid compartments **621**, **622** may be readily observed. The panels **623**, **624** may be coupled or joined along a other suitable technique. When coupled together, the panels **623**, **624** form a fillable void that may receive drainage fluid via a drainage tube **612** and a corresponding inlet port **616** that are located on an upper portion of at least one of the fluid compartments **621**, **622**. The panels **623**, **624** can also be flexible rather than rigid, such that the fluid compartments **621**, **622** can expand as they fill with drainage fluid.

(84) As further shown in FIG. **15**, the first and second fluid compartments **621**, **622** can be defined by one or more seams **625**, **626** that extend across a central region of the drainage bag assembly **610**. For instance, the illustrated embodiment includes a first seam **625** and a second seam **626** that are disposed between the first and second fluid compartments **621**, **622**. The seams **625**, **626** can couple one or more regions of the panels **623**, **624** together. The seams **625**, **626** can also define fold lines or regions where the drainage bag assembly **610** can fold when assembled.

(85) The seams can be made in various ways, such as via radio frequency (RF) welding, heat sealing, gluing, or any other suitable technique. The seams **625**, **626** can also be discontinuous, such that they do not block the flow of fluid between the fluid compartments **621**, **622**. For example, the seams **625**, **626** can be referred to as spot seams (or spot welds). In some embodiments, each seam **625**, **626** can comprise a series of spot seams (or spot welds). For instance, each seam **625**, **626** can comprise three, four, five, six, seven, eight or more spot seams (or spot welds) along a distance of between about 8 and about 16 inches. In particular embodiments, each seam **625**, **626** can comprise four, five, or six spot seams (or spot welds) along a distance of between about 8 and about 16 inches. And in more particular embodiments, each seam **625**, **626** can comprise five or six spot seams (or spot welds) along a distance of between about 8 and about 16 inches. In some of such embodiments, the drainage bag assembly **610** does not include other conduits (such as conduits **130** in FIG. **1**). In such embodiments, fluid can freely flow through the seamed regions **625**, **626** and between the first and second fluid compartments **621**, **622**.

(86) As illustrated, an outlet tube **613** can also be disposed between the fluid compartments **621**, **622**. The outlet tube **613** may allow the drainage fluid contained within the fluid compartments **621**, **622** to be selectively drained from or retained within the fluid compartments **621**, **622** via an output regulator **614**. The output regulator **614** may comprise a plastic or metal clip, in-line valve, rotatable valve, or any other suitable structure. At least one of the fluid compartments **621**, **622** may further comprise an outlet tube holder **615** that comprises a slot, loop, pocket, or hook that is configured to receive and reversibly retain outlet tube **613** in an at least partially upright or folded position. For example, in the illustrated embodiment, the outlet tube holder **615** comprises a plastic tube so as to define a cavity. When the drainage assembly **600** is in a packaged, folded, or filling configuration, a bottom end of the outlet tube **613** can be positioned within the cavity of the outlet tube holder **615**. The outlet tube **613** can be removed from the outlet tube holder **615** and allowed to hang downwardly into an extended position shown in FIG. **18B** during drainage of fluid from the fluid compartments **621**, **622**.

(87) As further shown in the illustrated embodiment, the fluid compartments **621**, **622** can comprise extension members **672**, **674** that couple to an extended outlet tube section **670**. For example, in FIG. **15** the fluid compartments **621**, **622** each comprise an extension member **672**, **674** that extends outwardly from the fluid compartment **621**, **622**. The extension members further couple to the outlet tube section **670** which extends from a central region of the drainage bag assembly **610**. The outlet tube section **670** is also coupled to the outlet tube **613** to allow drainage from the drainage bag assembly **610**.

(88) In some embodiments, the extension members **672**, **674** are integral with the fluid compartments **621**, **622**. For instance, the extension members **672**, **674** can be formed of the same panel material. The extension members **672**, **674** can also be defined by one or more seams **676**, **677**, **678**, **679**. If desired, the seams **676**, **677**, **678**, **679** can be configured to not allow the passage of fluid. In other embodiments, fluid can be allowed to flow into the extension members **672**, **674** and to the outlet tube section **670**. When the drainage bag assembly **610** is folded into an assembled state, the extension members **672**, **674** can also provide support for the outlet tube section **670**. For instance, the extension members **672**, **674** can be coupled and configured to retain the outlet tube section **670** in an extended configuration, as further discussed below in relation to FIG. **18B**.

(89) FIGS. **16A** and **16B** depict a portion of the drainage bag assembly **610** in the folded and/or assembled configuration. As shown therein, the drainage bag assembly **610** is folded such that the first fluid compartment **621** and the second fluid compartment **622** are parallel to one another, or side by side. The first fluid compartment **621** is also coupled to the second fluid compartment **622** such that the drainage bag assembly **610** can remain in the folded or assembled configuration during use.

(90) In the illustrated embodiment, the drainage bag assembly **610** includes a base or brace **640** that extends between the first and second fluid compartments **621**, **622**. For instance, the brace **640** can be coupled to an elongate member **651** of each of the first and second fluid compartments **621**, **622** to retain the drainage bag assembly **610** in the assembled configuration. A hanger **650** is also coupled to and extending upward from the base **640**.

(91) The hanger **650** can be configured to allow the drainage assembly **600** to be suspended from a patient, or from a support structure, such as a wheelchair, bed, a bed rail, or stand. As shown in FIGS. **16A** and **16B**, the hanger **650** can be positioned such that it is directed towards either side of the drainage bag assembly **610**. For instance, the hanger **650a** can be positioned towards the first fluid compartment **621**, or the hanger **650b** can be positioned towards the second fluid compartment **622**, as desired by the practitioner (e.g., a practitioner may suspend the drainage assembly **600** in either direction, depending on a desired orientation of the inlet port **616** and tube **612**). The hanger **650** may be formed as an integral unit using any suitable manufacturing technique, such as injection molding, casting, machining, etc. In other embodiments, the hanger **650** may be assembled from separate components using any suitable assembly technique. The hanger **650** may be formed from any suitable material, such as a polymeric material like polypropylene, polyethylene, blends thereof, etc.

(92) As further illustrated in FIGS. **16A-16B**, the hanger **650** may include a central portion **653**, a first extending member or arm **654**, and a second extending member or arm **655**. The central portion **653** may be coupled to the brace **640** and may also include a flexible or living hinge **658** such that a face of the central portion **653** can be configured to flex and/or bend towards the first and second fluid compartment **621**, **622** if desired. For instance, the hanger **650** can be bent towards either the first or second fluid compartment **621**, **622** during packaging and/or shipping. The hanger **650** can also be bent towards either the first or second fluid compartment **621**, **622** when being suspended from an object.

(93) The first and second arms **654**, **655** can also be coupled to the central portion **653** via a flexible or living hinge **656** such that the arms **654**, **655** are oriented in a plane of the face of the central portion **653** in the undeployed state, as shown in FIG. **16A**. The living hinge **656** may allow the

arms **654**, **655** to pivot or fold about the living hinge **656** approximately or at least 180 degrees relative to the plane of the face of the central portion **653** (e.g., at least 90 degrees in either direction). In other words, the arms **654**, **655** may be pivoted from the parallel orientation to a perpendicular orientation on either side of the central portion **653** when the hanger **650** is deployed, as depicted in FIG. **16B**. The arms **654**, **655** may include a support receiver **652** configured to be clipped over or disposed over a portion of a hospital bed rail. In other embodiments, the support receiver **652** may be configured to be clipped over or disposed over any suitable support, such as a wheelchair, a stand, etc.

(94) Although not depicted in FIGS. **16A** and **16B**, it will be appreciated that the drainage bag assembly **610** can further include one more covers (similar to covers **281**, **284** shown in FIG. **7** or cover **981** shown in FIG. **24A**). The drainage bag assembly **610** can further include one or more other features previously discussed, such as one or more graduations (like graduations **134**, **135** shown in FIGS. **5A-5C**), etc.

(95) FIG. **17** depicts an end view of a drainage assembly **600** that includes first and second fluid compartments **621**, **622** each having a cover **681**, **684** coupled thereto. As shown in FIG. **17**, the covers **681**, **684** can couple to an upper region of the first and second fluid compartments **621**, **622**, and drape downwardly over the outwardly facing surfaces of the fluid compartments **621**, **622**. In such a manner, fluid **605** within the fluid compartments **621**, **622** can be obscured from view by an observer. As previously discussed, a bottom portion of each cover **681**, **684** can also be lifted as desired to view the fluid **605** within the fluid compartments **621**, **622**.

(96) FIG. **17** also depicts a hanger **650** extending from a base **640** that couples the fluid compartments **621**, **622** together. As shown in FIG. **17**, the hanger **650** is configured to couple to a rail **602** or other structure. In the illustrated embodiment, the hanger **650** is depicted in a folded configuration or state, wherein each arm **654**, **655** is pivoted or folded about a hinge **656** towards the first fluid compartment **621**. The support receiver **652** is also shown disposed over a rail **602**. If desired, the arms **654**, **655** could also pivot or fold towards the second fluid compartment **622** (e.g., in instances where the rail is on the other side of the drainage bag assembly **610**). The hanger **650** can also pivot or fold about hinge **658** if required.

(97) As further shown in FIG. **17**, the fluid **605** height is substantially the same in each of the first and second fluid compartments **621**, **622** as the fluid can flow freely between the fluid compartments **621**, **622**. Prior to draining fluid **605** from the drainage bag assembly **610**, the extension members **672**, **674** and outlet tube section **670** are folded inwards towards the drainage bag assembly **610** and the outlet tube **613** is disposed in or housed within the outlet tube holder **615**.

(98) FIGS. **18A** and **18B** depict the drainage assembly **600** in a folded or assembled configuration during use. Specifically, FIG. **18A** depicts the drainage assembly **600** with the outlet tube **613** in a folded configuration, and FIG. **18B** depicts the drainage assembly **600** with the outlet tube **613** in an extended configuration. When folded, the fluid compartment **622** is defined at a bottom end by seam **625**. The drainage bag assembly **610** is also shown without covers **681**, **684** for ease of reference, but it is understood that one or more covers **681**, **684** could be coupled to the drainage assembly **600** if desired.

(99) With reference to FIG. **18A**, the outlet tube **613** can be disposed in an upright or folded configuration prior to draining fluid from the drainage bag assembly **610**. For instance, the outlet tube **613** can be disposed in the folded configuration while the drainage bag assembly **610** is being filled with fluid. In the folded configuration, the outlet tube is positioned or housed within the outlet tube holder **615**. The extension members **672**, **674** are also folded inwardly towards the drainage bag assembly **610**.

(100) When a practitioner desires to empty or drain fluid from the drainage bag assembly **610**, the outlet tube **613** can be transitioned to an extended or drainage configuration, as shown in FIG. **18B**. When transitioning to the extended configuration, the outlet tube **613** is removed from the outlet

tube holder **615**, pulled outwards away from the drainage bag assembly **610**, and pivoted downwards (e.g., between about 150-200 degrees, or about 180 degrees). In doing so, the outlet tube section **670** is also pivoted from a first position disposed inwards towards the drainage bag assembly **610** to a second position disposed outwards and extending from the drainage bag assembly **610**. In the extended or drainage configuration, the outlet tube **613** is also directed downwards for drainage.

(101) When transitioning to the extended configuration, the extension members **672**, **674** are also inverted and folded from a first position disposed inwards towards the drainage bag assembly **610** to a second position disposed outwards and extending from the drainage bag assembly **610**. In the extended position, the extension members **672**, **674** can support the outlet tube section **670** to help retain the outlet tube **613** in the downward orientation. The extension members **672**, **674** can also aid in keeping the outlet tube section **670** from kinking or bending which can restrict flow to the outlet tube **613**.

(102) After a practitioner empties or drains fluid from the drainage bag assembly **610**, the practitioner can transition the outlet tube **613** back to the folded configuration. It will thus be appreciated that the outlet tube **613** can be transitioned between the folded configuration of FIG. **18A** and the extended configuration of FIG. **18B** as desired.

(103) FIG. **19** depicts a drainage assembly **700** according to yet another embodiment. In FIG. **19**, the bottom section of the drainage bag assembly **710** is configured to angle and/or slope towards the outlet tube section **770** and outlet tube **713**. For instance, each fluid compartment **721** can be configured such that the seam **725** defines an angle or slope when the drainage bag assembly **710** is folded and assembled for use. As shown in FIG. **19**, the height **H2** on the first side or end of the fluid compartment **722** is greater than the height **H1** on the second side or end such that the bottom end of the fluid compartment **722** is not parallel with the top end. Configuring the fluid compartments **721**, **722** with a bottom that slopes and angles towards the extension members **772**, **774** and outlet tube section **770** can aid in directing the flow of fluid towards the outlet tube **713** for optimal drainage and emptying of the drainage bag assembly **710**.

(104) FIGS. **20A-23B** depict another embodiment of a drainage bag assembly **810**. FIGS. **20A** and **20B** depict a portion of the drainage bag assembly **810** in the folded and/or assembled configuration. As shown therein, the drainage bag assembly **810** is folded such that the first fluid compartment **821** and the second fluid compartment **822** are parallel to one another, or side by side. The first fluid compartment **821** is also coupled to the second fluid compartment **822** such that the drainage bag assembly **810** can remain in the folded or assembled configuration during use.

(105) In the illustrated embodiment of FIG. **20A-21**, the drainage bag assembly **810** includes a base or brace **840** that extends between the elongate members **851**. The base **840** may include a first base portion **840a** coupled to and extending laterally from one elongate member **851** and a second base portion **840b** coupled to and extending laterally from another elongate member **851**. The first base portion **840a** and the second base portion **840b** may be configured to fixedly couple together. For instance, the first and second base portions **840a**, **840b** may include passages **845** that engage with pins or protrusions **846** when the first and second base portions **840a**, **840b** are coupled together. Other coupling configurations, such as snap fit, adhesive, loop and hook, etc., are also contemplated within the scope of the disclosure. In some embodiments, the first and second base portions **840a**, **840b** may be configured to releasably couple together. The base **840** may further include a slot **847** configured for coupling of a hanger **850** to the base **840**.

(106) The hanger **850** may be coupled to and extend upward from the base **840**. The hanger **850** can be configured to allow the drainage bag assembly **810** to be suspended from a patient, or from a support structure, such as a wheelchair, bed, a bed rail, or stand. As shown in FIG. **20B**, the hanger **850** can be positioned such that it is directed towards either side of the drainage bag assembly **810**. For instance, the hanger **850a** can be positioned towards the first fluid compartment **821**, or the hanger **850b** can be positioned towards the second fluid compartment **822**, as desired by

the practitioner (e.g., a practitioner may suspend the drainage bag assembly **810** in either direction, depending on a desired orientation of the inlet port **816** and tube **812**). The hanger **850** may be formed from any suitable material, such as a polymeric material like polypropylene, polyethylene, blends thereof, etc.

(107) As further illustrated in FIGS. **20A-21**, the hanger **850** may include a central portion **853**, a first extending member or arm **854**, a second extending member or arm **855**, and a base coupler **863**. The central portion **853** may be coupled to the base **840** and may also include a flexible or living hinge **858** such that a face of the central portion **853** can be configured to flex and/or bend towards the first and/or second fluid compartment **821**, **822** if desired. For instance, the hanger **850** can be bent towards either the first or second fluid compartment **821**, **822** during packaging and/or shipping. The hanger **850** can also be bent towards either the first or second fluid compartment **821**, **822** when being suspended from an object.

(108) The first and second arms **854**, **855** can also be coupled to the central portion **853** via a flexible or living hinge **856** such that the arms **854**, **855** are oriented in a plane of the face of the central portion **853** in the undeployed state, as shown in FIG. **20A**. The living hinge **856** may allow the arms **854**, **855** to pivot or fold about the living hinge **856** approximately or at least 180 degrees relative to the plane of the face of the central portion **853** (e.g., at least 90 degrees in either direction). In other words, the arms **854**, **855** may be pivoted from the parallel orientation to a perpendicular orientation on either side of the central portion **853** when the hanger **850** is deployed, as depicted in FIG. **20B**. The arms **854**, **855** may also include a support receiver **852** configured to be clipped over or disposed over a portion of a support structure (e.g., like a hospital bed rail).

(109) The hanger **850** may be coupled to the base **840** using any suitable assembly technique. For instance, as depicted in FIGS. **21-23B**, the base coupler **863** of the hanger **850** can be disposed within the slot **847** of the base **840** such that a cylindrical central portion **866** is disposed within the slot **847**, an upper portion **857** is disposed above the slot **847**, and a lower portion **859** is disposed below the slot **847**. As depicted in FIGS. **22A** and **22B**, the hanger **850** is oriented perpendicular to a longitudinal axis of the elongate members **851** in a pre-locked configuration. As shown in FIG. **22B**, the lower portion **859** is positioned at a base of ramps **864** which are disposed on a bottom surface of the first and second base portions **840a**, **840b**. The ramps **864** are inclined downwardly away from the bottom surface and define a channel **865**.

(110) FIGS. **23A-23B** illustrate the hanger **850** in a locked configuration. In the locked configuration, the hanger has been rotated 90 degrees in a first direction from the pre-locked configuration such that it is oriented parallel to the longitudinal axis of the elongate members **851**. During rotation, the lower portion **859** engages with the ramps **864** and is turned such that it moves to a position where it is disposed within the channel **865** at the end of the rotation. The channel **865** is disposed between the ramps **864** and is configured to restrict rotation of the hanger **850** in a second direction to decouple the hanger **850** from the base portions **840a**, **840b**. For instance, the ramps **864** can include shoulders that restrict rotation of the hanger **850** in the second or reverse direction. When in the locked configuration, the base portions **840a**, **840b** can also be locked in their engaged position such that they cannot be separated or otherwise pulled apart. The bag assembly **810** can thus remain in the assembled or folded configuration for use. In other embodiments, the hanger **850** can be rotated in a reverse direction (after being locked or engaged) by applying a sufficient force such that the hanger **850** can optionally be removed from the channel **865**, and the base portions **840a**, **840b** can be optionally separated.

(111) Although not depicted in FIGS. **20A** and **20B**, it will be appreciated that the drainage bag assembly **810** can further include one more covers (similar to covers **281**, **284** shown in FIG. **7** or cover **981** shown in FIG. **24A**). The drainage bag assembly **810** can further include one or more other features previously discussed, such as one or more graduations (like graduations **134**, **135** shown in FIGS. **5A-5C**), etc.

(112) As shown in FIGS. **24A** and **24B**, in certain embodiments, a bodily fluid drainage assembly

900 can include a drainage bag assembly **910** comprising a cover **981** that can be formed from or otherwise include an opaque material (or at least partially opaque material capable of obscuring the appearance of a fluid within the drainage bag assembly **910** when in use), and that may define a sleeve to selectively cover portions of the drainage bag assembly **910**. For example, the cover **981** may be formed from polyvinyl chloride, polyurethane, vinyl, polymeric, or any other suitable material. The cover **981** may comprise front and back panels **989** that define a cavity configured to receive the drainage bag assembly **910**. Side ends or edges of the panels **989** may be welded together and lower ends or edges of the panels **989** may be uncoupled defining a lower opening **997** to the cavity. Upper ends or edges of the panels **989** may define an upper opening **996** and may include one or more fasteners **998** configured to selectively couple the upper ends together to close the upper opening **996**. The fasteners **998** may be of any suitable type, such as snaps, clips, hook-and-loop, zippers, buttons, etc. As depicted in FIG. 24B, the cover **981** is located adjacent to and is configured to obscure a fluid compartment **921**.

(113) The cover **981** can include one or more volume indicators **985**. The illustrated first volume indicator **985** includes a window **982** and one or more graduations **983**. A variety of configurations for the window **982** and the graduations **983** are possible. For example, a variety of shapes are possible for the window **982**, and the number and arrangement of the graduations **983** may be varied. In the illustrated embodiment, the window **982** defines a permanent opening through the cover **981** and is fully encompassed by solid or unbroken portions of the cover **981**. The window **982** defines a small, vertically oriented longitudinal slot. Only a small portion of the fluid compartment **921** is visible through the window **982** when the cover **981** is in an obscuring orientation. An approximate volume level can be determined when a top level of the drainage fluid is visible through the window **982**, such as by comparing the level of the drainage fluid to the graduations **983**. Due to the fixed relationship between the upper end of the cover **981** and the fluid compartment **921**, the graduations **983** can provide a substantially accurate assessment of the approximate liquid volume when the cover **981** is in the obscuring orientation.

(114) The cover **981** may include a second volume indicator **986**. The second volume indicator **986** includes a recess, such as a notch or cutout **987**, and a set of graduations **988**. A bottom end of the cutout **987** is at a position that is horizontally offset and/or spaced vertically from an upper end of the window **982**. Due to the difference in vertical positions between the cutout **987** and the window **982**, a top level of the drainage fluid can remain below the cutout **987** at all times that the window **982** is used in determining the approximate volume of the drainage fluid, and the top level of the drainage fluid can remain above the window **982** at all times that the cutout **987** is used in determining the approximate volume of the drainage fluid. In some embodiments, the cover **981** may include volume indicators similar to first and second volume indicators **985**, **986** disposed on both the front and back panels **989** configured to determine the approximate volume of the drainage fluid within first and second drainage bags.

(115) In FIG. 24B, the cover **981** is shown in the obscuring orientation. In other words, the cover **981** is shown disposed over the drainage bag assembly **910** and obscuring at least a portion of the fluid compartment **921**. The cover **981** may be disposed in the obscuring orientation by unfastening the fasteners **998** to open the upper opening **996** of the cover **981** and sliding the drainage bag assembly **910** into the cavity of the cover **981** such that a hanger **950** extends at least partially through the upper opening **996** and an output regulator **914** and an output tube **913** extends at least partially through the lower opening **997**. The hanger **950** may be similar to any of the previously disclosed hangers of the present disclosure. Alternatively, the drainage bag assembly **910** may be slid into the cavity through the lower opening **997** of the cover **981**. When the cover **981** is in the obscuring orientation, the fasteners **998** may be closed to close the upper opening **996** and secure the cover **981** in the obscuring orientation. To transition the cover **981** to a viewing orientation, a portion of the cover **981** may be displaced upwardly (e.g., from the bottom edge such as by the drainage tube **912**) to reveal at least a lower portion of the fluid compartment **921**. Alternatively,

the fasteners **998** may be opened to open the upper opening **996** and a portion of the cover **981** may be displaced downwardly to reveal at least an upper portion of the fluid compartment **921**.

(116) As shown in FIG. 25, in certain embodiments, a bodily fluid drainage assembly **1000** can include a drainage bag assembly **1010** comprising a cover **1081** that can be formed from or otherwise include an opaque material (or at least partially opaque material capable of obscuring the appearance of a fluid within the drainage bag assembly **1010** when in use). For example, the cover **1081** may be formed from polyvinyl chloride, polyurethane, vinyl, polymeric, or any other suitable material. The cover **981** may comprise front and back panels that can obscure fluid compartments **1021**, **1022** when in use. The front and back panels of the cover **1081** may be configured to obscure substantially all of the fluid compartments **1021**, **1022**. As depicted in FIG. 25, a top edge of the front panel of the cover **1081** is coupled (e.g., welded) to a top edge of the front fluid compartment **1021**. The weld extends substantially across a width of the fluid compartment **1021** such that the cover **1081** obscures the fluid compartment **1021** from top to bottom and from side to side. In other words, the cover **1081** is coupled to the fluid compartment **1021** adjacent an elongate member **1051** of the hanger **1050**. In some embodiments, the weld may follow a contour of the elongate member **1051**. The fluid compartment **1022** and back panel of the cover **1081** can be configured likewise.

(117) The illustrated embodiment of FIG. 25 depicts an inlet port **1016** in fluid communication with the fluid compartment **1022** of the drainage bag assembly **1010**. Alternatively, the fluid port **1016** may be in fluid communication with the fluid compartment **1021**. An elbow connector **1094** is rotationally coupled to and extends upward from the inlet port **1016** at one end and is fluidly coupled to a drainage tube **1012** at an opposite end. The elbow connector **1094** is configured to be rotated relative to the inlet port **1016** to facilitate redirecting the drainage tube **1012** (e.g., such that the drainage tube **1012** can be oriented at any direction in relation to the assembly **1010**). The elbow connector **1094** can include a fixed angle bend ranging from about 30 degrees to about 60 degrees, from about 40 degrees to about 50 degrees, and can be about 45 degrees relative to a vertical axis of the elbow connector **1094**. In other embodiments, the elbow connector **1094** may include a swivel joint disposed at the bend of the elbow connector **1094**. The swivel joint may allow the angle of the elbow connector **1094** to be adjustable from about zero degrees to about 90 degrees, from about 30 degrees to about 60 degrees, and from about 40 degrees to about 50 degrees relative to the vertical axis of the elbow connector **1094**.

(118) A rotation tab or wing **1098** may be coupled to the elbow connector **1094**. The rotation tab **1098** may extend outwardly from the vertical axis and be disposed adjacent the bend of the elbow connector **1094**. The user may grasp the rotation tab **1098** to rotate the elbow connector **1094** to change an orientation of the drainage tube **1012**. In other embodiments, the elbow connector **1094** may not include the rotation tab **1098** and the elbow connector **1094** may be rotated by grasping a body of the elbow connector **1094**. An anti-rotation handle **1095** may also optionally be fixedly coupled to an upper portion of the inlet port **1016**. The anti-rotation handle **1095** may include at least one lateral extension configured to be gripped by a user to rotationally secure the inlet port **1016** relative to the fluid compartment **1022**. When grasped by a user, the anti-rotation handle **1095** can prevent rotation of the inlet port **1016** as the elbow connector **1094** is rotated. If the inlet port **1016** is rotated, the material of the fluid compartment **1022** may tear or rip and compromise the fluid integrity of the fluid compartment **1022**. The anti-rotation handle **1095** may be used in cooperation with the rotation tab **1098** to rotate the elbow connector **1094** to re-orient the drainage tube **1012** without compromising the fluid integrity of the fluid compartment **1022**. In other embodiments, no anti-rotation handle **1095** is used.

(119) FIG. 25 illustrates the drainage bag assembly **1010** including a retention band **1093**. The band **1093** may be fixedly or releasably coupled to side edges of the fluid compartments **1021**, **1022**. The band **1093** may be formed from the same material used to form the fluid compartments **1021**, **1022**, or a different material. The band **1093** may be about one inch wide and have a length that accommodates expansion of the fluid compartments **1021**, **1022** when filled with fluid. The band

1093 may be configured to retain an outlet port **1013** in an upward vertical orientation when the fluid compartments **1021**, **1022** are not being drained. A distal portion of an output regulator **1014** may be selectively disposed inside of the band **1093** to retain the outlet port **1013** in an upward vertical orientation. The band **1093** can also be configured to be lifted and/or stretched upwards such that the outlet port **1013** can be transitioned from the upward retained position to a position where it extends outwardly and/or downwardly for drainage. In other embodiments, the band **1093** may include portions coupled to and extending from each of the fluid compartments, **1021**, **1022**. The portions may be selectively coupled using any suitable fastener, such as a button, a snap, adhesive, hook-and-loop material, etc.

(120) Any methods disclosed herein comprise one or more steps or actions for performing the described method. The method steps and/or actions may be interchanged with one another. In other words, unless a specific order of steps or actions is required for proper operation of the embodiment, the order and/or use of specific steps and/or actions may be modified.

(121) References to approximations are made throughout this specification, such as by use of the term “substantially.” For each such reference, it is to be understood that, in some embodiments, the value, feature, or characteristic may be specified without approximation. For example, where qualifiers such as “about” and “substantially” are used, these terms include within their scope the qualified words in the absence of their qualifiers. For example, where the term “substantially perpendicular” is recited with respect to a feature, it is understood that in further embodiments, the feature can have a precisely perpendicular configuration.

(122) Similarly, in the above description of embodiments, various features are sometimes grouped together in a single embodiment, figure, or description thereof for the purpose of streamlining the disclosure. This method of disclosure, however, is not to be interpreted as reflecting an intention that any claim require more features than those expressly recited in that claim. Rather, as the following claims reflect, inventive aspects lie in a combination of fewer than all features of any single foregoing disclosed embodiment.

(123) The claims following this written disclosure are hereby expressly incorporated into the present written disclosure, with each claim standing on its own as a separate embodiment. This disclosure includes all permutations of the independent claims with their dependent claims. Moreover, additional embodiments capable of derivation from the independent and dependent claims that follow are also expressly incorporated into the present written description.

(124) Without further elaboration, it is believed that one skilled in the art can use the preceding description to utilize the invention to its fullest extent. The claims and embodiments disclosed herein are to be construed as merely illustrative and exemplary, and not a limitation of the scope of the present disclosure in any way. It will be apparent to those having ordinary skill in the art, with the aid of the present disclosure, that changes may be made to the details of the above-described embodiments without departing from the underlying principles of the disclosure herein. In other words, various modifications and improvements of the embodiments specifically disclosed in the description above are within the scope of the appended claims. Moreover, the order of the steps or actions of the methods disclosed herein may be changed by those skilled in the art without departing from the scope of the present disclosure. In other words, unless a specific order of steps or actions is required for proper operation of the embodiment, the order or use of specific steps or actions may be modified. The scope of the invention is therefore defined by the following claims and their equivalents.

Claims

1. A bodily fluid drainage assembly, comprising: a first fluid compartment comprising a first elongate member; a second fluid compartment comprising a second elongate member, the second fluid compartment being in fluid communication with the first fluid compartment, wherein the first

and second fluid compartments are configured to be parallel to one another when in an assembled configuration; a base extending between the first elongate member and the second elongate member such the first elongate member and the second elongate member are spaced apart from one another in the assembled configuration; and a hanger configured to couple to the base to suspend the bodily fluid drainage assembly from a support, wherein the base comprises a slot for coupling the hanger to the base.

2. The bodily fluid drainage assembly of claim 1, wherein the base comprises a first base portion and a second base portion that are coupled together in the assembled configuration.

3. The bodily fluid drainage assembly of claim 2, wherein the slot is defined by the first base portion and the second base portion.

4. The bodily fluid drainage assembly of claim 3, wherein the hanger is inserted into the slot and turned to lock a first base portion and a second base portion together in the assembled configuration.

5. The bodily fluid drainage assembly of claim 1, wherein the first and second fluid compartments are defined by one or more seams.

6. The bodily fluid drainage assembly of claim 1, further comprising: a first cover coupled to the first fluid compartment and configured to obscure observation of at least a portion of a bodily fluid through a first panel of the first fluid compartment when the bodily fluid is retained within the first fluid compartment.

7. The bodily fluid drainage assembly of claim 6, wherein the first cover comprises at least one volume indicator.

8. The bodily fluid drainage assembly of claim 6, wherein the first cover is configured such that at least a portion of the first cover is removable from the bodily fluid drainage assembly.

9. The bodily fluid drainage assembly of claim 6, wherein the first cover is coupled to the bodily fluid drainage assembly at an upper end of the first fluid compartment, and wherein a lower end of the first cover can be displaced so as to transition the first cover from the obscuring orientation to a viewing orientation.

10. The bodily fluid drainage assembly of claim 1, wherein the first fluid compartment further comprises: an inlet port configured to couple to a drainage tube and configured to receive drainage fluid from the drainage tube.

11. The bodily fluid drainage assembly of claim 1, further comprising an outlet tube, wherein the outlet tube is disposed on an outlet tube section that is configured to extend outwardly from the first and second fluid compartments, wherein the outlet tube is configured to be disposed in an upright configuration when the outlet tube section is folded inwardly, and wherein the outlet tube is disposed in a downward configuration when the outlet tube section is extended outward.

12. A bodily fluid drainage assembly, comprising: a first fluid compartment comprising a first elongate member; a second fluid compartment comprising a second elongate member, the second fluid compartment being in fluid communication with the first fluid compartment, wherein the first and second fluid compartments are configured to be parallel to one another when in an assembled configuration; a base extending between the first elongate member and the second elongate member such the first elongate member and the second elongate member are spaced apart from one another in the assembled configuration; a hanger configured to couple to the base to suspend the bodily fluid drainage assembly from a support, wherein the base further comprises a slot for coupling the hanger to the base; and a first cover configured to obscure observation of at least a portion of a bodily fluid through a first panel of the first fluid compartment when the bodily fluid is retained within the first fluid compartment.

13. The bodily fluid drainage assembly of claim 12, wherein the base comprises a first base portion and a second base portion that are coupled together in the assembled configuration.

14. The bodily fluid drainage assembly of claim 13, wherein the slot is defined by the first base portion and the second base portion, and wherein the hanger is inserted into the slot and turned to

lock the first base portion and second base portion together in the assembled configuration.

15. The bodily fluid drainage assembly of claim 12, wherein the first and second fluid compartments are defined by one or more seams.

16. The bodily fluid drainage assembly of claim 12, further comprising: a second cover coupled to the second fluid compartment and configured to obscure observation of at least a portion of the bodily fluid through a second panel of the second fluid compartment when the bodily fluid is retained within the second fluid compartment.

17. The bodily fluid drainage assembly of claim 12, wherein the first cover comprises at least one volume indicator.

18. A method of suspending a drainage system from a hospital bed rail, comprising: obtaining a drainage system, wherein the drainage system comprises: a first fluid compartment comprising a first elongate member; a second fluid compartment comprising a second elongate member, the second fluid compartment being in fluid communication with the first fluid compartment, wherein the first and second fluid compartments are configured to be parallel to one another when in an assembled configuration; a base extending between the first elongate member and the second elongate member such the first elongate member and the second elongate member are spaced apart from one another in the assembled configuration, wherein the base comprises a slot; and a hanger configured to couple to the base to suspend the drainage system from a support; inserting the hanger into the slot in the base; and coupling the hanger to the hospital bed rail.

19. The method of claim 18, further comprising: draining bodily fluid from the drainage system, wherein draining comprises changing an outlet tube from an upright configuration to a downward configuration.

20. The method of claim 18, wherein the base comprises a first base portion and a second base portion that are coupled together in the assembled configuration.
